

Using the MarEng Plus Glossary

This introduction offers guidance on the use of the MarEng Plus glossary which is available for learners and teachers within the MarEng Plus program. The MarEng Plus glossary has been compiled by the authors of the program material. The glossary is based on the previous MarEng glossary and has been complemented with terms, phrases, definitions and explanations from the Elementary, Intermediate and Advanced sections of the new MarEng Plus program.

The aim of this introduction is to offer suggestions to teachers about how to use the glossary whilst working with the MarEng Plus program in the classroom. It should be noted that the definitions and explanations provided in the MarEng Plus glossary are valid within the context of MarEng Plus. The same words or concepts may be defined differently in other contexts.

The authors of the MarEng Plus material felt that the glossary should not remain a passive collection of words but, if possible, should be used actively within the program. The following page therefore contains ten suggestions about how to use the glossary in the classroom. We hope you find the ideas useful and that the glossary fulfills its purpose as a comprehensive and interactive maritime lexis.

Ten suggestions for the classroom

1 Building conceptual structures

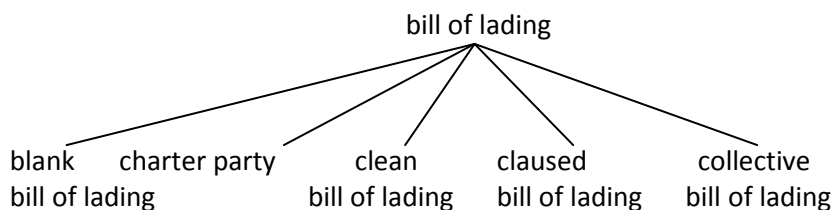
Instructions for teachers:

Ask the students to build conceptual structures using headwords chosen from the glossary. They should display their findings in a mind map or conceptual structure diagram (see examples included). The visual way of displaying the information should help students to memorise the vocabulary and definitions.

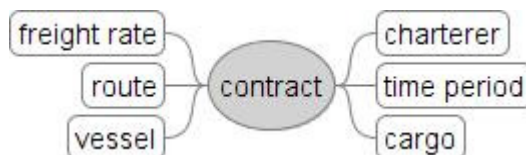
Instructions for students:

Find concepts related to headwords, for example *ship*, *cargo*, *valve*, *instrument*. Use the “Find” function on the computer (Ctrl + F). Draw a mind map or build a conceptual structure starting with the headword and placing the subordinate concepts and coordinate concepts where they belong in relation to the other concepts. Compare the definitions of the concepts in the glossary and memorize the differences.

For example, start with the headword **bill of lading** and find subordinate concept by typing “bill of lading” into the “Find” field. Then go on to build a conceptual structure. You might end up with something similar to the diagram below.



Or start with the headword **contract**, for example, and draw a mind map which includes the central concept node and, subsequently, satellite concepts related to the central concept. You might end up with something similar to the mind map below. Read the definitions in the glossary and memorize the type of relation between the central concept and the satellite concepts.



2 Presentation skills: giving a short talk in English

Instructions for teachers:

Ask the students to prepare and give a short presentation on vocabulary (5-10 items) from the MarEng Plus program.

An introduction to presentation skills e.g. linguistic elements (phrases used in presentations), structure, body language, PowerPoint (slides) can be given in combination with this exercise.

Instructions for students:

Select a number of keywords (e.g. 5-10 items) from a unit in the MarEng Plus program. Prepare to give a short PowerPoint presentation on the words. You may be creative with the presentation but it must include the definition of the word or phrase taken from the MarEng Plus glossary. Audio or audio visual aids (video, sound technology) may be used to discuss the pronunciation of the word; visual aids (image, photo) to explain the meaning or concept in question. The PowerPoint should also include examples of the word or phrase in a maritime context (note: these examples should be different to those given in the program).

3 Crosswords

Instructions for teachers

This exercise may be done in groups or individually. The group or individual should swap crosswords with another group and solve the clues.

There are various sites available online which provide simple programs for building crosswords.

Instructions for students

Choose a theme from one of the units in the MarEng Plus program e.g. the marine environment. Devise crosswords using the vocabulary found in the unit. Use the MarEng Plus glossary to create the clues.

Example:

Across

1 *damage caused to water, air, or land by harmful substances or waste (9)*

Answer: pollution

Once you have finished your crossword, swop with another group or with a partner. Solve the clues and complete the crossword.

4 Alphabet Soup

Instructions for teachers:

This is a variant of the classical crossword exercise. Alphabet soups may be created either manually (with grid) or automatically with the help of one of the many (online) programs devised to this effect. Your soup may contain not only hidden words, but also a hidden message, such as a definition, a topic, etc.

As a hint, in the instructions, students may be told whether there is a hidden message, or not, or the total number of hidden words.

Instructions for students:

Try to find the words hidden in this alphabet soup. Do the words form any kind of message?

5a Creating an individual/class student glossary

Instructions for teachers

The MarEng Plus glossary contains a huge number of words, about 1,700 to be precise. There are, of course, too many words for students to learn them all by heart. Ask your students to compile their own personal glossary by completing a spreadsheet template. Every week, they should add twenty new words to their glossary. At the end of the semester/course, all student glossaries may be merged into one.

Return the complete list to the students and ask them to study it. Evaluate the students' knowledge by organising a test on the vocabulary from the compiled list.

Instructions for students

With the help of a spreadsheet create your own personal glossary based on the MarEng Plus program. Each week add twenty words to your list.

Enter the following information in your spreadsheet:

Column 1. Maritime term

Column 2. Meaning/definition

Column 3. Synonyms, related words (if any)

Column 4. Antonyms (if any)

Example:

	A	B	C	D
1	Maritime Term	Definition	Synonyms and/or related words	Antonyms
2	<i>bosun</i>	<i>a petty officer in charge of ratings</i>	<i>boatswain donkeyman</i>	
3	<i>starboard</i>	<i>right side of a vessel</i>	<i>right</i>	<i>port</i>

The spreadsheet will allow you to put your glossary in whatever alphabetical order you might need it, according to entry, definition, synonym or antonym. You may even include extra columns, for examples a column for specific topics (e.g., pollution contingency, dangerous goods, ISPS code, etc.) or for translation into your own language.

At the end of the semester/course, all student glossaries may be merged into one.

5b Spelling quiz

Instructions for teachers

Choose a letter of the alphabet. Ask the students to learn how to spell of all the words/phrases listed under that particular letter in the students' glossary. They must use the International Civil Aviation Organisation (ICAO) alphabet. Organise a quiz/test (students may be divided into teams). The winner/s should be allowed to choose a letter for the following class.

Instructions for students

You will be given a letter of the alphabet. Using the vocabulary list which the class has compiled learn how to spell all the words listed under this letter. You must use the International Civil Aviation Organisation (ICAO) alphabet.

Example

Maritime Mike Alpha Romeo India Tango India Mike Echo

You will be tested with a quiz. The winner or winning team will be allowed to choose the letter for the following class.

6 Bingo!

Instructions for teachers:

This activity may be used to reinforce listening skills as well as vocabulary. Ask your students to define a list of vocabulary to be revised. This may be related to a given topic, e.g. "Dangerous Goods". Give all your students a grid of four/ five columns width by three / four rows height, as in the example below:

	PROPELLER		COURSE	BRIDGE
VESSEL	TO STEER	RUDDER		BOW
TO MOOR	DONKEYMAN	LIGHTHOUSE	RATINGS	
TUG		MIDSHIPS	STERN	BOSUN

They should fill it in with 15 to 20 words from the list provided. Then, the teacher will read the words aloud, either at random or in alphabetical order. Students have to cross out any word they hear that is written on their grid. If a word is to be spelt, always use the ICAO/SMCP phonetic alphabet (e.g.: “Ship” = “SIERRA – HOTEL – INDIA – PAPA”).

Instructions for students:

With the help of the maritime list provided by you teacher, complete the grid with 15-20 words of your choice. The teacher will read the words aloud randomly. Once you hear one of the terms written on your grid, cross it out. When you have completed either a vertical or a horizontal line, shout, “line!” If you happen to be the first to complete the whole grid, shout “Bingo!” You are the winner!

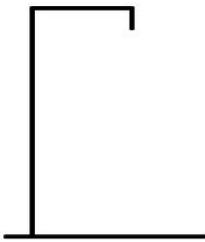
7 Hangman

Instructions for teachers:

This is a classic game for practising vocabulary. Students will be divided into two teams, and one team must guess the other team’s word, before the “hangman” diagram is completed. Letters should be spelt phonetically (i.e., “SIERRA”, “OSCAR”, “BRAVO”, etc.). Topics or vocabulary lists may be negotiated beforehand.

Instructions for students:

You will be divided into two opposing teams. Each team will try to guess the other team’s word, before the full hangman’s diagram is completed. Every time your team fails, a part of the body (the head, the body, the arms, etc.), will be added to the basic diagram. If your team succeeds, a letter will be added. All letters must be spelt phonetically.



Your guess: --- --- --- ---

8 The Pyramid

Instructions for teachers:

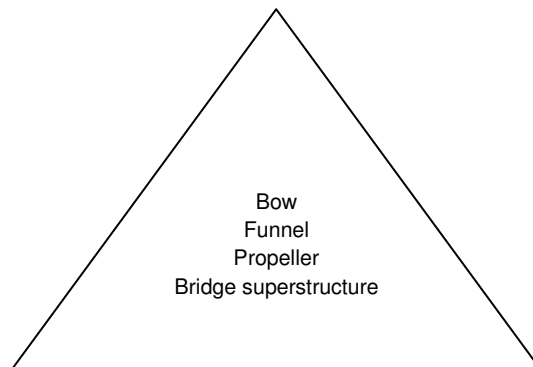
Students are to work in teams of 2-5. They should try to complete the longest pyramid, by entering words related to a given topic. Shortest words should come first (at the top), longest words should

placed last (at the bottom). Ideally, the first row (top) should contain only one syllable words. Second row two syllable words, and so on.

Instructions for students:

Try to create the highest possible pyramid by entering different words related to the topic given by your teacher. Place the shortest words at the top of the pyramid progressing to the longest words at the bottom. E.g.

Topic: PARTS OF A VESSEL



9 Scrambled definitions

Instructions for teachers:

Negotiate with your students what topic/vocabulary will be used. Every item of vocabulary should be written on a card. All definitions of the vocabulary selected should be written on a different set of cards. Once done, the two sets of cards should be shuffled, so that definitions do not match entry-words. Lay down the vocabulary cards vertically in a column to the left and the definitions to the right (jumbled). Students have to match the definitions to the vocabulary.

As a variant, images may be used instead of definitions. In addition, you may ask students to reorder entries in alphabetical order.

Instructions for students:

Try to match the following words with their corresponding definitions. There is only one possible order.

10 Creating a story

Instructions for teachers:

Negotiate with your students which topic/vocabulary will be used. The vocabulary list to be revised should not be too high (maximum 20-30 words).

Instructions for students:

Either individually or in small groups (no more than four), try to devise a story where you include as many words as possible from the list provided by your teacher. You may negotiate the topic and/or situation with your teacher. If possible, try to support your story with photographs, flashcards or slides.